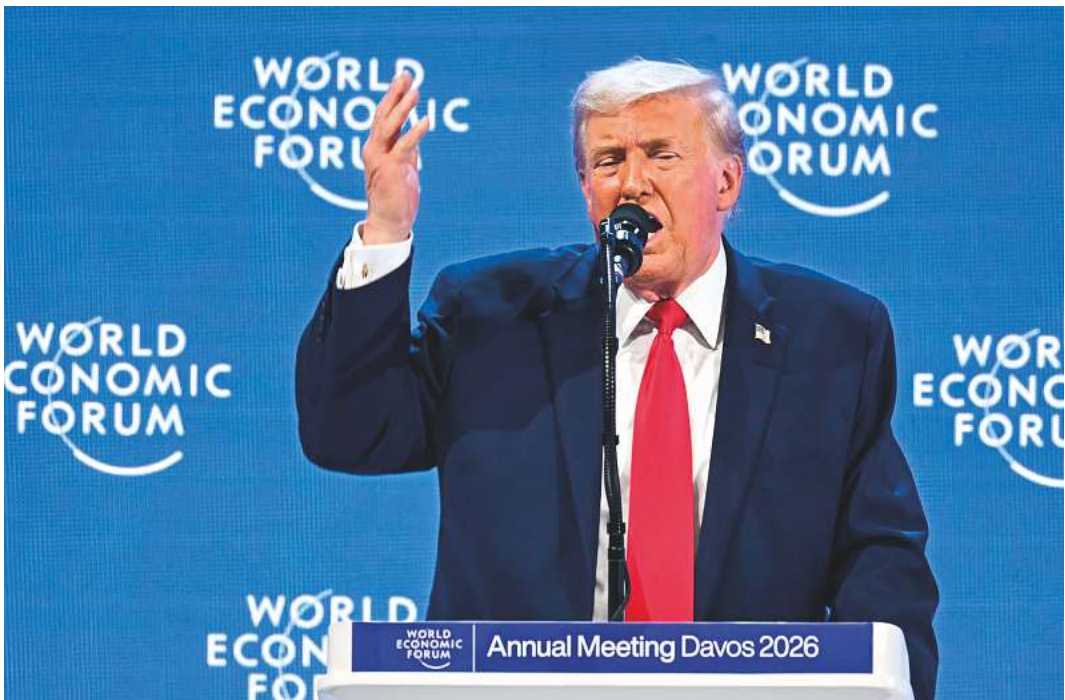


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AFP

■ US President Donald Trump delivers a special address during the World Economic Forum (WEF) annual meeting in Davos yesterday.

Trump rules out force to annex Greenland

SET TO ANNOUNCE FIRST CHARTER OF BOARD OF PEACE

DAVOS

US President Donald Trump demanded immediate talks on acquiring Greenland in a hardline speech at Davos yesterday, but said that while the United States possessed “unstoppable force” it would not use it to take the Arctic island from Denmark.

“It’s the United States alone that can protect this giant mass of land, this giant piece of ice,” Trump told a packed audience of global political and business leaders in the Swiss ski resort who queued for more than an hour to listen.

“That’s the reason I’m seeking immediate negotiations to once again discuss the acquisition of Greenland by the United States.”

Denmark has “a choice,” he said.

“You can say yes, and we will be very appreciative. Or you can say no and we will remember. A strong and secure America means a strong Nato.”

But Trump appeared to rule out the threat of military action against fellow Nato member Denmark — which he branded “ungrateful” — that has threatened to tear the transatlantic alliance apart.

Unstoppable force

“We probably won’t get anything unless I decide to use excessive strength and force where we would be, frankly, unstoppable, but I won’t do that,” Trump said, adding that it was probably the “biggest statement I made.”

It’s the United States alone that can protect this giant mass of land, this giant piece of ice. That’s the reason I’m seeking immediate negotiations to once again discuss the acquisition of Greenland by the United States.

Donald Trump
US President

“I don’t have to use force. I don’t want to use force. I won’t use force.”

Trump however lambasted Europe on a number of fronts from Greenland to tariffs and the economy, saying it was “not heading in the right direction”.

‘Rupture’

Trump’s claims over mineral-rich Greenland have completely overshadowed the meeting in Davos, where he landed by helicopter, stepping onto a red carpet laid in the snow.

He arrived some two hours behind schedule, after an electrical issue earlier forced Air Force One to turn back to Washington and switch planes.

Canada’s Prime Minister Mark Carney warned at Davos on Tuesday of a “rupture” to the US-led system, in a speech which won a standing ovation.

Nato chief Mark Rutte told Davos yesterday that “thoughtful diplomacy” was needed, as Trump’s claims over Greenland

provoke an existential crisis for the group. “There are these tensions at the moment, there’s no doubt,” said Rutte, who has been dubbed the “Trump whisperer” for his ability to deal with the US president.

Rutte also pushed back against Trump after he said he doubted Nato would come to the aid of the United States if asked. “I tell him, yes they will,” Rutte said.

Treated ‘so unfairly’

Trump however repeated his doubts on Nato during his speech, saying Washington was treated “so unfairly.”

France called meanwhile for a Nato exercise in Greenland “and is ready to contribute to it”, French President Emmanuel Macron’s office said.

Macron had warned at Davos on Tuesday against US attempts to “subordinate Europe”, and blasted Trump’s “unacceptable” threats to impose tariffs on allies over Greenland.

Europe has threatened countermeasures after Trump turned up the pressure by threatening levies of up to 25 per cent on eight European countries for backing Denmark.

Greenland’s prime minister said Tuesday that his tiny population of 57,000 must be prepared for military force.

Today, meanwhile, Trump is set to formally announce the first charter of his so-called “Board of Peace,” a body for resolving international conflicts with a \$1 billion price tag for permanent membership.

— AFP

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Emirates’ Cabin Crew Village to house 12,000

UAE airline plans multi-billion-dirham housing project for long-term growth

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Emirates Airline has signed an agreement to develop a new, purpose-built Cabin Crew Village at Dubai Investments Park, marking a multi-billion-dirham investment to support the airline’s expanding workforce and long-term operational plans.

The project will deliver a modern residential and mixed-use community designed to house up to 12,000 cabin crew members. Groundbreaking is scheduled for the second quarter of 2026, with the first phase expected to be completed in 2029. The development will be delivered under a long-term lease arrangement.

Future growth trajectory

The agreement was signed by Ali Mubarak Al Soori, Emirates’ chief procurement and facilities officer, and Khalid Bin Kalban, vice-chairman and chief executive of Dubai Investments, in the presence of senior executives

20

residential buildings of 19 floors each will make up the village

from both organisations. The planned Cabin Crew Village will comprise 20 contemporary residential buildings, each rising to 19 floors, offering a mix of one-, two- and three-bedroom apartments.

The design focuses on convenience and community living, reflecting the airline’s effort to align staff housing with its future growth trajectory.

“Our cabin crew are central to the experience Emirates delivers to customers,” Al Soori said. “This investment is part of our broader commitment to supporting their wellbeing by offering living spaces designed around their needs and lifestyles. The Cabin Crew Village will provide everything our crew need within a single, thoughtfully planned development.”

He added that the project also supports Emirates’ longer-term transition plans linked to Al Maktoum International Airport and the airline’s continued expansion over the coming years.

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